

ART
TREND

the Indian Art Market Report FY23' by Grant Thornton Bharat and Indian Art Investor. According to Ashish Anand, CEO and Managing Director, DAG (formerly Delhi Art Gallery), the total art market size including galleries and dealers is around ₹3,000 crore. That's an exponential growth from just around ₹15-20 crore at the turn of the century. "The total value of the Indian art market then was the value of just one painting today," says Anand. Talking of the record-breaking sale of Husain's *Gram Yatra*, Anand says, "It has put Indian art on the world map..." He adds that while the market has grown significantly over the last 25 years, the real growth will come now. "We are at a tipping point. By 2030, I expect the Indian art market to be around ₹10,000 crore." Of course, we are miniscule compared to the global art market that is around $65 billion. "But we are growing when the global art market has stagnated," says Siddanth Shetty, Chief Administrative Officer, AstaGuru Auction House. "We grew around 11.7 per cent in 2023 compared to the previous year, while the global art market plateaued. That is simply because demand and supply is starting to come from India," he adds.

The 13 sections that make up Husain's Gram Yatra (Above); A painting by MF Husain (Facing page)

What is fuelling growth?

There are several reasons for it including a growing economy, higher disposable incomes, growing awareness of art as an asset class and the changing demography of the collector. Apart from the second and third generations of affluent families adding to their collections, there is a whole breed of young entrepreneurs and professionals who have the reach and disposable income to acquire art. "Naturally you end up collecting art that you can relate to traditionally or culturally. And that is why Indian art is growing because the clientele itself is growing," says Shetty. He believes that this is helping the contemporary art market grow as artists like Subodh Gupta and Atul Dodiya are being collected by younger audiences in their 30s and 40s. "These collectors are interested in bold, new mediums which break the traditional mould," he adds.

At Saffronart, nearly 30-40 per cent of the clientele is below 40 years old and most of them purchase contemporary art. "It meets their aesthetic sensibilities and is also available at an easier price point



"The record-breaking sale of Husain's Gram Yatra has put Indian art on the world map. We will now see interest from a lot of global collectors who till date were purchasing Chinese art, but not that much Indian art"

Ashish Anand,
CEO and Managing Director, DAG